FORWARD DEPLOYED ENGINEER | CANDIDATE ASSIGNMENT

Why the MoveInSync app sits at 4.64 stars, and what to fix first

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4.64
Overall rating from 114,857 ratings

7.1%
Of all-time ratings are 1 or 2 stars

27.2%
Of the 3,000 newest written reviews are 1 or 2 stars

26.6%
Of low-star reviews cite the app failing to open or log in

Recommendation in brief

The rating is already strong (4.64). The remaining gap comes from a small group of unhappy people who write reviews, and what they write is concentrated in a few repeatable failures. **Fix first, in this order:**

- **P0 - App reliability:** login/OTP failures, forced logouts and the app not opening after an update. This is the largest single bucket of low-star reviews, and it also blocks access to the cab number, OTP and SOS when an employee needs them.
- **P0 - Live location and ETA trust:** the biggest single commute-related theme. Employees report ETAs that climb and then drop suddenly, wrong pickup locations and stale tracking.
- **P0 - Booking and trip-change clarity:** unclear confirmation, missing monthly schedule view, and pickup time or cab changes with no explanation.
- **P1 - Check-in/no-show handling, notifications and support reachability:** smaller by volume, but about three in four reviews that mention them are low-star.
- **P2 - Review hygiene:** stop forcing a rating on every trip, and reply to low-star reviews with a triage tag so each one feeds a ticket.

Success is measured with operational metrics first and the star rating second. I recommend no rating target until a baseline from product telemetry exists, because the store score is a lagging, noisy signal.

1. What the public data shows

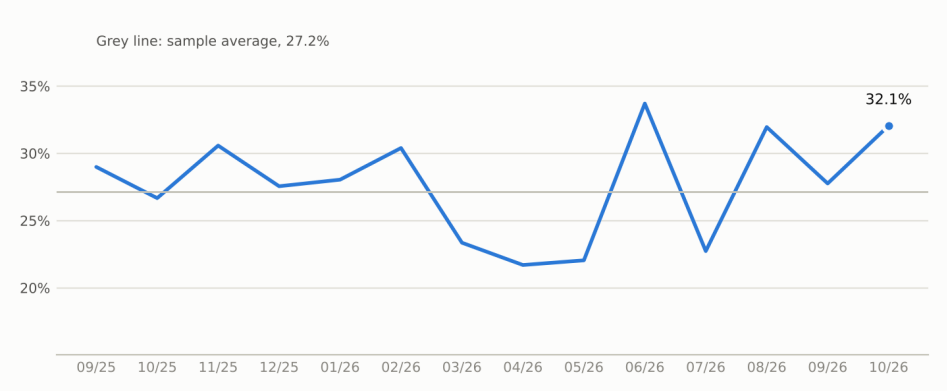
Data. I pulled the 3,000 newest written reviews (21 Sep 2025 to 9 Oct 2026, English, India store) from the public listing with an open-source scraper, tagged each review with one or more themes, and checked the tags by hand on about 100 reviews. Two of the three reviews in my earlier screenshot (29 Jun and 7 Jul 2026) appear in this dataset, which confirms the right listing.

Star	All-time ratings	Share	Newest 3,000 written reviews	Share
1 star	7,334	6.4%	727	24.2%
2 stars	837	0.7%	88	2.9%
3 stars	1,230	1.1%	79	2.6%
4 stars	7,293	6.3%	194	6.5%
5 stars	98,158	85.5%	1,912	63.7%

Written reviews skew negative: 27.2% are 1 or 2 stars versus 7.1% of all ratings, because unhappy people are far more likely to write. The review sample therefore shows *what unhappy users complain about*, not how large the problem is across the user base.

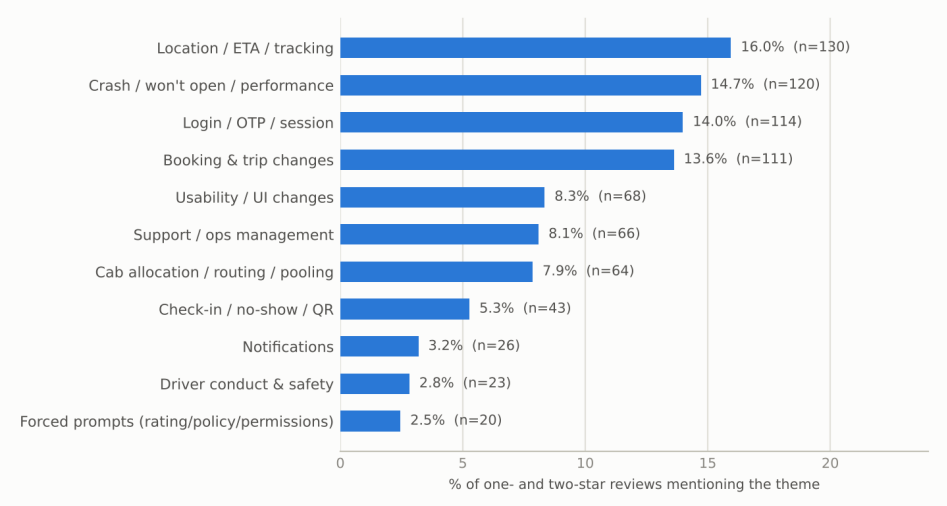
2. Findings

Finding 1 - The problem is chronic, not a recent regression. The monthly share of 1 and 2 star reviews moves between 21.7% and 33.7% with no sustained trend (pooled across all reviews in each period: 27.7% for Sep to Mar, 26.8% for Apr to Oct; a simple average of the monthly percentages gives 27.9% and 27.4%, the same flat picture). With about 250 reviews a month, swings of five or six points are within sampling noise, so single-month spikes (Jun and Aug 2026) should not be read as incidents without telemetry to back them.



Share of 1 and 2 star reviews by month, 3,000 newest written reviews. Sep 2025 and Oct 2026 are partial months (69 and 78 reviews).

Finding 2 - Four themes account for most specific complaints. Of 815 low-star reviews, 220 (27%) say only things like "worst app" and cannot be diagnosed. Among the rest, the leading themes are below. Themes overlap, so shares add up to more than 100%.



Themes among the 815 one- and two-star reviews. Keyword tagging, multi-label; "generic negative" (220) and "other" (62) are not shown.

Finding 3 - App access failures are the largest bucket. Counting reviews that cite either crashes and failure to open (120) or login, OTP and session problems (114), the union is 217 reviews, or 26.6% of all low-star reviews and more than a third of those with specific content. These are not edge cases: reviewers describe OTPs that never arrive, being logged out after 5 to 10 minutes of inactivity while a cab is waiting (no cab number, OTP or helpdesk access), an "not installed from Play Store" error, and the app refusing to open after an update until it is reinstalled.

Finding 4 - Some themes are rare but almost always negative. The table shows how often a review that mentions the theme is low-star. A high rate means the issue is a rating killer when it happens, even if it is infrequent.

Theme	Low-star reviews	Share of this theme's reviews that are 1-2 star
Login / OTP / session	114	82.0%
Check-in / no-show / QR	43	76.8%
Support / ops management	66	76.7%
Crash / won't open / performance	120	75.9%
Cab allocation / routing / pooling	64	74.4%
Forced prompts (rating, policy, permissions)	20	74.1%
Notifications	26	66.7%
Booking and trip changes	111	62.0%
Location / ETA / tracking	130	52.0%
Driver conduct and safety	23	33.3%
Usability / UI changes	68	32.9%

Finding 5 - Direction over the last 90 days (directional only). Crash and performance mentions rose from 13.3% to 18.8% of low-star reviews, booking from 13.0% to 15.5%, while login fell from 15.3% to 10.1%. The comparison rests on 207 recent versus 608 earlier low-star reviews, so treat it as a prompt to check telemetry, not as a finding.

Finding 6 - Part of the pain is not the app. About 17% of low-star reviews point at cab allocation and pooling, support and operations management, or driver conduct (some reviewers say outright that the app is fine and their company's transport team is the problem). These need to reach customer transport desks and account teams, not the app backlog. A tenant (company) dimension in telemetry would let us separate them.

A possible rating-moment effect. Twenty low-star reviews (2.5%) complain about being forced to rate every trip, re-accepting the transport policy on each launch, or microphone permission prompts. A couple say they left a 1-star review only because the app would not let them skip. The count is small, but it is a cheap, safe change to test.

3. What to build, in order

Priority reflects review volume *and* severity (commute-critical or safety-relevant issues rank higher even when rare). Owners are suggestions. Each action can start the next day.

Priority	Action	Why (evidence)	How we will know
P0 Mobile + Auth backend	**Make access reliable.** (1) Instrument the OTP funnel (requested, delivered, entered, verified) by channel and carrier. (2) Track crash-free sessions and failed cold starts by app version and phone brand. (3) Keep an active trip usable without re-login: cab number, trip OTP, call driver, SOS and helpdesk stay reachable. (4) Investigate the "not installed from Play Store" error (likely an install-integrity check misfiring) and open-failures after updates. (5) Roll out releases at 1%, 10%, then 100% with an automatic halt on crash rate.	26.6% of low-star reviews; 82% of login reviews and 76% of crash reviews are low-star.	OTP delivery success and median time to login; crash-free users; forced-logout rate during active trips; login-related support contacts per 1,000 users.
P0 Mobile + Maps/Routing	**Make location and ETA trustworthy.** Log location age and ETA error per trip. Show "last updated" when GPS is stale instead of a live-looking marker. Smooth the ETA so it does not climb and then drop. Stop the map camera resetting zoom every few seconds. Fix pickup-pin placement. Alert operations when updates stop.	Largest theme (16.0%). The most-liked low-star review in the sample is about map zoom resets. Reviewers describe ETAs that rise then drop suddenly.	Location age (median, P90); ETA absolute error; ETA reversals per trip; tracking complaints per 1,000 trips; missed pickups.
P0 Mobile + Booking backend + Design	**Make booking and changes unmistakable.** One confirmation summary (date, shift, pickup point, ride type) with Confirmed / Pending / Failed / Cancelled states. Add a month-wide schedule view. Send a message with the reason when a pickup time or cab changes or is cancelled (pooling changes were a repeated complaint). Hide irrelevant ride options. Test the flow with real employees and roll back if completion drops.	13.6% of low-star reviews; 62% of booking reviews are low-star. The 7 Jul 2026 review describes a new two-step shuttle flow that caused a mis-booking.	Booking completion and abandonment; duplicate or failed bookings; wrong-date incidents per 1,000 attempts; unexplained-change complaints.
P1 Mobile + Transport Ops	**Fix check-in, no-show and reminders.** Remind the employee when the vehicle crosses the pickup point (the 29 Jun 2026 suggestion). Show check-in status. Define a grace and dispute path when vehicle arrival and check-in disagree. Track delivered notifications, not just queued ones.	Only 5.3% of low-star reviews but 77% of check-in reviews are low-star, and a no-show mark has a direct cost for the employee.	Disputed no-shows; notification delivery latency; check-in completion; missed pickups.
P1 Support + Customer Success	**Reach help, and route non-app issues.** Make helpdesk reachable from every screen, including logged-out. Tag review themes by owner and send allocation, pooling and driver-conduct themes to customer transport desks with a tenant dimension.	8.1% cite support or management; 77% of those reviews are low-star. About 17% of low-star reviews are service issues.	Support contacts per 1,000 trips; time to first response; share of service-issue themes routed with an owner.
P2 Product + Growth	**Review hygiene.** Make in-app trip feedback skippable and not required every trip; ask for policy consent once, not on each launch; request microphone access only when a feature needs it. Reply publicly to 1 and 2 star reviews with a triage tag. Do not ask only happy users to rate on the Play Store, which Google's policy does not allow.	20 low-star reviews (2.5%) cite forced prompts. Replying lets a reviewer update their rating after a fix.	Share of 1-2 star reviews citing prompts; reply rate on low-star reviews; rating changes after reply.

What changed from my first draft. My first version used only three screenshot reviews and ranked by severity. The full sample confirms location, booking and check-in as real themes but shows that app access (login, OTP, crashes) is just as large and had been left out. It is now P0.

4. Execution plan and measurement

When	Work	Output
Days 1 to 3	Baseline from telemetry: OTP funnel, crash-free sessions, location age, ETA error, booking funnel. Reproduce the top reported paths with product and operations.	Baseline snapshot; a ticket for each P0 theme with an owner.
Days 4 to 7	Validate complaints against logs (is the "not installed" error an integrity-check false positive? why do OTPs not arrive for some carriers?).	Root-cause notes; a go or no-go list.
Week 2	Ship small fixes behind feature flags: session handling during active trips, stale-location label, booking confirmation states, skippable rating prompt.	Flagged releases at 1% rollout.
Weeks 3 to 4	Usability test the booking flow with employees; widen rollout; compare before and after on task success, funnel metrics and review themes.	Before and after readout; rollback if guardrails worsen.
Every week	Re-run the review pipeline, update the scorecard, close the loop from review theme to ticket to released fix.	One-page weekly report.

Scorecard (answers "How are our Play Store ratings?" each week).

- **Store:** overall rating, new-review volume, share of 1 and 2 star reviews (rolling 7 and 28 days), top three themes among low-star reviews, and the reply rate.
- **Access:** OTP delivery success, crash-free users, forced-logout rate during trips.
- **Ride confidence:** location age, ETA error, late or missed pickups, notification latency.
- **Booking and trust:** booking completion, wrong-date incidents per 1,000 attempts, disputed no-shows, support contacts per 1,000 trips.

Because the store rating is lagging and noisy, I would not promise a specific rating increase. A better commitment is a falling share of low-star reviews citing each fixed theme within two release cycles.

5. Method, tools and limits

How I got here. I collected the 3,000 newest English-language reviews from the India Play Store listing for com.moveinsync.ets on 10 Oct 2026 with the open-source *google-play-scraper* Python package (public data, within the platform's limits), plus the listing's rating histogram. I tagged each review with one or more of 11 themes using keyword rules. I read about 100 reviews (70 the first rules left untagged, 30 tagged ones), found two rule bugs and several missing themes (pooling, forced prompts, session expiry), fixed them and re-ran. I analysed the results with pandas and drew the charts with matplotlib. I used Claude (an AI assistant) to help draft the scraper, the tagging rules and the wording of this report; all numbers come from the scraped data, and I checked them against the output files.

Limits. (1) Written reviews are not representative of all users, as the star table shows. (2) Keyword tags are a first pass: 27% of low-star reviews carry no usable detail and about 10% of those with detail stay unclassified; I did not measure tag accuracy formally. (3) The sample covers English reviews on the India store only. (4) I had no access to telemetry, support tickets or transport logs, so there are no causal claims, and priorities mix review volume with my judgement of severity. (5) Theme shares between periods rest on small counts.

Repeatable. The script (*review_pipeline_v2.py*) takes one command and writes the tagged reviews, monthly and theme summaries and a weekly report. Run it every week, spot-check about 50 tags, and compare the themes with the previous week.